alcovia

AHEAD OF THE CURVE

The World's First Ambition Building Program
for Teenagers

Founder's Note

Sahil Puri

DPS RK Puram, IIM Indore

Nestle • Panasonic • Flipkart • Meesho • Nothing

- Led 2400 cr of revenue at Flipkart at the age of 23.
- Scaled up Tecno to 660 crores from 50 Lakhs within 9 months on Flipkart.
- 1st Employee of CMF, Nothing's subbrand. CMF grew to 1000 crores in 8 months.

Alcovia is derived from the term Alcove. For us, it means a safe space to nurture teens.

The idea of Alcovia took shape in my mind while interacting with B-school students when I started giving lectures on Marketing. The brightest minds at premier institutes like IIM A, B, C, MDI etc. had 10X the aptitude I did, but lacked critical thinking. They were also unable to communicate effectively, potentially limiting their growth. This made me wonder whether these students were ready for high-impact, real-life boardroom conversations.

I am not from an education background, and I believe that is an advantage. During the 2 years I spent working at Nothing, I started interacting with parents and teenagers over weekends to understand what was broken.

After interacting with 8,000 PG & UG students, I came to the conclusion that the best time to lay the groundwork for building such foundational skills is when people are at an impressionable age. Hence, from the very beginning, we were convinced that our program needed to cater to teens aged 11–16, because by the time you are 18, you are already 80% of the person you will be.

Two years' worth of conversations, ideating, and brainstorming led to the creation of Alcovia, a program the equivalent of which the world has never seen. I deeply believe that the carefully curated interventions we plan over the year for our cohort will lead to a significant change in their overall approach to life.

Alcovia isn't easy, and we will not pretend that it will be. As much as parents can love us for who we are, the final decision to join, when we extend the invite, should and will be the decision of the potential Alcovian. The student is our customer.

To parents reading this, I will quote one parent who has been with us from the beginning:

> *"It takes a village to raise a child well, Alcovia is that village for us."*
>
> An Alcovia Parent

Our inputs over a year will change the way your child thinks and make them act with intention, taking up projects and missions in life that they align with consciously.

Alcovia works not because we bring the best people to guide your child; it works because the energy of similarly driven teenagers in our program is infectious. This is a community, a third space for children to call their own, get guidance, collaborate, and share with like-minded individuals.

By the time your child graduates from school, they will have:

- Built multiple startups
- Understood multiple industries in depth
- A roster of mentors they can reach out to for support
- Become more perceptive to social causes
- Mentored younger Alcovians

With such a strong body of work behind them, admissions to good universities will be a by-product of them being an Alcovian. We define success by seeing our students develop a mission for life; everything else is transitional.

The Ambition Formula

Ambition for us is an equation with 3 vectors :

AMBITION = VISION × EXECUTION × DRIVE

It is a multiplier equation. One without the other will make none of it work.

Vision •

How big can you think?

1

Execution •

Are you resilient enough to power through the grunt work when the going gets tough?

2

Drive •

Are you physically, emotionally, mentally & socially capable of executing big vision projects?

3

In a world where AI will ensure that career pivots happen every half a decade, building strong foundations of being ambitious for each Alcovian is the only recipe for success.

Hence, this requires hyper personalised interventions for each Alcovian. And for us, these weekly inputs come from folks from Harvard, Cambridge, UCL and guidance coaches who have come from the top schools of India.

To those who have had the privilege of finding a mentor, you understand the sheer change of thought they are capable of bringing in one's life. At Alcovia, each Alcovian meets over 15 industry movers and shakers in a year, increasing the probability of them finding one such life-changing mentor.

> *"In pursuit of happyness, Will Smith found his mentor on a subway by chance, at Alcovia, we bring the chance to you."*

Vision

Strategy & Exposure

01 Chief of Staff (CoS)

- The child's personal growth architect, the main point person for all things Alcovia.
- The CoS will collaborate with the Alcovian on tracking syllabus, calendaring & time-management to ensure superior academic & non-academic outcomes.
- They will also help the child set up and work towards their personal, academic and professional goals, and ensure alignment/ accountability for all outcomes.
- They act like buddies to Alcovians while also taking the mature calls of aligning any sort of support needed for the Alcovian or the parents. (Inputs for the mindset/deepwork/guidance coach)

02 Guidance Coach

- A long-term guidance partner who uncovers the child's authentic aspirations, aligns choices with identity, and shapes a post-school path rooted in clarity, not convention.
- They will enable discovery of what truly excites the child, facilitate mentor discussions, and nudge them to gain experience in their areas of interest.
- Responsible for backtracking what the Alcovian wants to do at the age of 30, and co-creating the roadmap to be best at it.

03 Personalized Roadmaps

- Three roadmaps for the year will be created in collaboration with the Alcovian and their parents, as well as CoS and Guidance Coach:
- Academic • quarterly milestones on academic goals (e.g., exam/test results, competency on subjects, etc.) which will culminate into overall percentage improvement over the year.
- Personal • one personal goal which will be taken up as a project for the year, for example, if public speaking is a concern for the child, we will work with them to plan how to become better at it by setting monthly binary goals.
- Domain Mastery • based on interest & aptitude, create a plan for the year, for industry/domain discovery and learning with the objective of getting closer to understanding the true calling.

04 Industry Discovery Workshops

- 10 curated industry workshops in the year expose students to real-world fields through practitioner-led sessions & live problem-solving simulations.
- Students don't just listen; they analyse, debate and present solutions.
- Students gradually move from curiosity to clarity about where they truly belong, while developing essential soft skills like presenting, communicating, collaboration and team-work.
- Post every workshop, a deep dive with CoS on which soft skills to improve & how; 9th & 10th grade Alcovians also create industry depth reports on size of industry, growth rate, consumer trends, etc.

05 The Titan Series

- Every Alcovian hosts their own professionally produced podcast interview with a seasoned industry veteran.
- Students prepare, research and lead thoughtful conversations that demand clarity, confidence and intellectual presence.
- These recorded dialogues form a visible body of work, demonstrating genuine engagement, not resume claims. Over time, students build voice, credibility & a personal brand.

06 Mentor Calls

- Every month, students are matched with accomplished professionals in a 1:1 virtual call, aligned to their evolving interests.
- With structured preparation, they lead focused conversations to understand the realities of roles, industries and career paths. These interactions replace assumption with insight.

07 Student Success Office

- Alcovia has a plethora of experts in various fields ranging from academics (tutors) to sports, fitness, nutrition, as well as institutions like Olympiad training centres, SAT preparation centres, on its panel.
- We take monthly reviews of all Alcovians and submit areas of improvement basis feedback to Alcovians and parents. This management of all tutors, coaches and academies is taken up by Alcovia.

Execution

Real-World Proof

01 Friction Labs

- Designed as controlled exposure to real-world unpredictability, Friction Labs are immersive team challenges that push students beyond comfort.
- Whether pitching to strangers, mapping business operations or creating public content, students learn to navigate uncertainty with composure.
- Failure is not avoided; it is analysed and refined into growth. Resilience becomes a practiced skill.
- Students run businesses for a day, visit factories & offices to understand how the practical world runs, and do things that they would otherwise feel are uncomfortable.

02 Social Incubator

- We don't want them to just 'check a box.' The Social Incubator is about looking at a broken system and saying, 'I can help fix this.'
- Building the heart of a leader, not just the resume. This social work stream is done in groups over 90 days.

03 Venture Lab

- Once interests begin to crystallise, students are guided to build something of their own; a product, service, or an initiative.
- Students earn real revenue, go through the 0 to 1 journey of building their own startup, and realise that being a founder is more hard work than just glamour.

04 The Narrative Arc

- A resume lists what they did. A story reveals who they are.
- We help your child step out from behind the grades and find their own voice. We capture the moments that define them so the world sees the person.
- Over years, building their own personal brand is the best form of signal of the depth of interest in a particular field or industry.

By the time your child graduates from school, they would have built multiple startups, understood multiple industries in depth, and have a roster of mentors they can call. With such a strong background, good universities will be a by-product.

Drive

Bio & Psycho-Social Engineering

01 Precision Bio-Protocol

- We offer a quarterly assessment providing insight into nutritional status, key health markers, allergies, and relevant genetic indicators.
- Reports are reviewed with specialist input and presented with clear interpretation for parents. Confidential. Voluntary. Informative; not prescriptive.
- Q1 to Q4: Quarterly nutritionist input personalised to each Alcovian. Q2*: Bloodwork to understand what nutrients are missing. Q3*: Allergen tests to eliminate allergy-causing food elements. Q4*: Health/Wellness panels to understand metabolic health, organ function, and any underlying health conditions. *Optional & paid for separately.

02 Physical Conditioning

- A structured quarterly fitness assessment conducted by a certified trainer to understand the Alcovian's strength, mobility, endurance, and coordination levels.
- Parents receive clear, objective insight into overall physical capacity and developmental markers.

03 Mindset Engineering

- We will provide proactive, structured sessions with a qualified mindset coach to strengthen emotional regulation, self-awareness, and confidence.
- This ensures that we are able to prevent any burnouts, manage heartbreaks, deal with failures, talk through any peer pressure incidents, etc.

04 The Deep Work Protocol

- A structured system that teaches them to manage attention, reduce distraction, and use time with intention.
- Led by the Chief of Staff and supported by a specialist, the protocol will help translate long-term ambition into disciplined daily action.
- This will enable each Alcovian to get more out of each hour of focus work that they put in, reducing social media addiction & other distracting elements.

05 The Syndicate

- Each Alcovian is part of a small, carefully curated peer group called "The Syndicate"; a consistent circle that learns and grows together through shared emotions, fears, challenges, successes, and honest conversations.
- It becomes a trusted third party, beyond home and school, where aspiration and vulnerability can coexist and students develop rare depth in connections.
- Every month, this group comes together with no curriculum and no pressure; only conversation. Alcovians speak freely, listen deeply and learn to hold space for one another. In a world of surface-level interaction, this becomes a rare environment of trust and psychological safety.

06 Peer Knowledge Exchange

- We believe every Alcovian is an expert in something.
- Alcovians step forward to guide other Alcovians in their areas of strength, reinforcing mastery of the topic. Teaching becomes both a learning accelerator and a powerful affirmation of self-belief.

07 Family Alignment Sync

- We facilitate the conversations that matter, turning conflict into connection.
- Because Alcovians don't just need their parents as managers; they need their parents on their team.
- These are a bunch of fun activities we do to make sure this relationship stays strong, and each parent & Alcovian empathises with the other to understand their perspective.

08 Digital Detox Retreats

- When was the last time your child sat in silence and just... thought? Our Digital Detox is a breath of fresh air.
- No screens. No pressure. Just nature and the space to hear their own thoughts again.
- *Opt-in basis for each Alcovian. Paid over and above the program fee.

Mentors Associated with Alcovia

Madhav Sheth
CEO, AI+ SMARTPHONE, FORMER VP & CEO REALME
- Harvard Business School

Chef Gauri Varma
FOUNDER, CONFECT & G'S PATISSERIE
- Oxford University

Jivraj Singh Sachar
FOUNDER, INDIAN SILICON VALLEY CAPITAL & ISV PODCAST
- St. Xavier's College

Nishant Chahar
FOUNDER, ALGOPREP, EX-MICROSOFT
- NSUT

Nikunj Dang
FORMER MD ACCENTURE STRATEGY
- Yagnum

Vipul Gupta
AI STRATEGIST, GOOGLE
- IIM Ahmedabad

Devansh Jain
FOUNDER & CEO, CULTURE CIRCLE
- IIM Ahmedabad

Arpit Sharma
HEAD OF SMART PRODUCT, NOTHING
- SRCC

Rajan Punatar
DIRECTOR, CATEGORY HEAD AT FLIPKART
- IMT, Nagpur

Nishant Larioia

FOUNDER, THE PACT

- GNLU

Aanchal Kapoor

DELHI HIGH COURT PRACTICING LAWYER

- NUS Faculty of Law

Ali Rehan

QUANT ANALYST, TOWER RESEARCH

- IIT Bombay, Stanford

Suhas Repally

SENIOR BRAND MANAGER, PEPSI

- IIM Calcutta

Preeti Sundan

CHAIRPERSON, UPSC

- LSE

Rohit Gandhi

FOUNDER, WION (WORLD IS ONE NEWS)

- Carleton University

Satish Reddy Eadala

DEVELOPMENT DIRECTOR, EA SPORTS

- Indian School of Business

Amrendra Saxena

DIRECTOR, ROCKET GROWTH @COUPANG

- XLRI Jamshedpur

Naveen Kapoor

NATIONAL CHIEF, ANI

- MICA

What People Say

Voices from parents, students, mentors, and academia.

PARENTS

"I have started observing positive changes in Aryaana. She is now opening up, having conversations, and is becoming a more confident self. Alcovia team has put in sincere efforts, & that I appreciate."

Mr. Vishal Jindal Founder, Biryani By Kilo

PARENTS

"Alcovia has been able to put something as abstract as the path over the next 4 years, into measurable goals for the next 6 months, which is a very gentle wake-up call for kids like Prisha and is nudging her in the right direction."

Ms. Shalini Regional Sales Head, WION

KIDS

"I get to learn about real careers like journalism, UI/UX design and more, helping me discover what I'm truly interested in. No other place gives me this much confidence to try new things."

Aanya

KIDS

"I've made friends who cheer me on, help me out when I'm stuck, and celebrate my little wins. Being part of such a group makes one feel special and I love how we push each other to be our best selves."

Ruhan

MENTORS

"These days, all HR heads are searching for candidates with the right attitude rather than the right knowhow, something that Alcovia is beautifully building in the teens of today, increasing their employability in the longer run."

Yudhisthir Naruka
Head of HR, Nothing Technologies

MENTORS

"I am amazed to see the opportunities that Alcovia is enabling for students as young as Aksh, who in 8th class, is building the knowhow on how to build brands. I had not even thought of something like this when I was his age!"

Madhav Sheth Ex CEO Realme, Honortech

ACADEMIA

"What stood out to me about Alcovia is how they're making students experience what careers are like, what it takes to reach there, and help them hone their skills in that domain."

Pooja Sharma Counsellor, GD Goenka

ACADEMIA

"I'm very happy to see that Alcovia is focused on upskilling and academics, yet at the same time uniquely focused on development of life skills and providing a community."

Vithika Ma'am Vice Principal, Excelsior American

Alcovia in Action

Our mentors don't just lecture; they engage, challenge, and inspire.

Devansh Jain
Founder, Culture Circle • Shark Tank India

Vipul Gupta
Google • Teaching AI at Work

Nikunj Dang

Former Managing Director, Accenture Strategy • Teaching Consulting

Learning from those who've built

Every month, each Alcovian meets industry leaders, both in group workshops and one-on-one sessions. These aren't passive lectures. Students analyse, debate, and present real solutions to real-world challenges.

From AI and entrepreneurship to consulting and brand strategy, our workshops are led by practitioners who've built at the highest levels, and who bring that rigour to every session with our Alcovians.

Students don't just listen; they lead conversations, challenge assumptions, and walk away with frameworks they can apply immediately. Over time, this builds structured thinking, industry awareness, and the kind of decision-making maturity that sets them apart.

"Our workshops are where exposure meets execution."

The World's First

Ambition Building Program for Teenagers

Join our WhatsApp Community

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AHEAD OF THE CURVE